

PAPER_278 — Sombrero Dust Ring UQFF Gravitational Ring Resonator: ω_{ring} and r_{ring}

Author: Daniel T. Murphy **Module:** SOMBRERO_UQFF_MODULE.cpp (UQFF 2.0) **Session:** 77 — March 2026 **Framework:** Unified Quantum Field Framework (UQFF 2.0) **Status:** Complete — embedded in SOMBRERO_UQFF_MODULE.cpp **Whitepaper Series:** 278/1000 **DOI (Provisional):** UQFF-2026-278-RING

Abstract

The Sombrero Galaxy (M104) possesses the most visually prominent equatorial dust lane of any nearby galaxy, appearing as a sharp dark band bisecting the galaxy's luminous bulge. We model this ring within the UQFF framework as a **Gravitational Ring Resonator**: an annular mass concentration at radius $r_{\text{ring}} = r/3 = 7.867 \times 10^{19}$ m whose orbital motion generates a pure oscillatory gravitational perturbation $F_{\text{ring}}(t) = A_{\text{ring}} \cdot \cos(\omega_{\text{ring}} \cdot t)$ at the reference point r . This paper derives the Dust Ring UQFF Orbital Resonance Frequency $\omega_{\text{ring}} = \sqrt{GM/r_{\text{ring}}^3} = 1.650 \times 10^{-14}$ rad/s, the ring orbital period $T_{\text{ring}} = 2\pi/\omega_{\text{ring}} = 12.08$ Myr, and the proximity-enhanced ring amplitude $A_{\text{ring}} = 9 \cdot f_{\text{ring}} \cdot g_{\text{base}} = 2.14 \times 10^{-12}$ m/s². The $9\times$ proximity enhancement factor arises from the inverse-square law applied at the ratio $r/r_{\text{ring}} = 3$.

UQFF Discovery: Novel application of UQFF calibration constants ($? = 5.0 \times 10^{-4} \text{ day}^{-1}$, $[\text{SSq}] = 0.57$) uniquely enabling this analysis establishing a new connection in the UQFF framework not present in Standard Model treatments.

1. Observational Motivation

1.1 The Sombrero Dust Lane

The Sombrero Galaxy (NGC 4594 / M104) is classified as an Sa/S0 galaxy at distance ~ 9.5 Mpc ($z = +0.0063$). Its defining optical feature is an equatorial dust lane visible in projection against the galaxy's extended bulge. This dust structure:

- Lies at approximately 1/3 to 1/4 of the half-light radius from the galactic centre
- Contains a substantial fraction of M104's cold ISM dust mass
- The total molecular gas and dust mass is estimated at $\sim 10^8$ – 10^9 M_{sun}
- Is dynamically stable — no evidence of radial inflow or rapid dispersal

As a stable ring at $r_{\text{ring}} = r/3$, it can be modelled within UQFF as a coherent oscillating mass concentration imposing a periodic boundary condition on the vacuum field at the reference point r .

1.2 Distinction from the Andromeda HI Ring (PAPER_275)

In PAPER_275 (Andromeda), a decaying HI ring was modelled as $F_{\text{ring}} = A_{\text{ring}} \cdot \exp(-\alpha \cdot t) \cdot \cos(\omega_{\text{ring}} \cdot t)$ — an exponentially decaying oscillation corresponding to a transient tidal feature. The Sombrero dust ring is fundamentally different:

Feature	Andromeda (PAPER_275)	Sombrero (PAPER_278)
Ring type	HI neutral gas, tidal	Dust, equatorial, settled
Age	Transient (~ 10 Gyr decay)	Stable, permanent
Decay	$\exp(-\alpha \cdot t)$ present	No exponential decay

Feature	Andromeda (PAPER_275)	Sombrero (PAPER_278)
Form	$F = A \cdot \exp(-\alpha t) \cdot \cos(\omega t)$	$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{\cos}(\omega \mathbf{t})$ (pure oscillatory)
α (decay rate)	1/(10 Gyr)	0 (stable ring)

The absence of exponential decay in Sombrero's ring term reflects the ring's settled, gravitationally stable configuration — it has been dynamically relaxed into a long-lived equatorial structure.

2. Theoretical Derivation

2.1 Ring Radius

The dust ring is positioned at approximately 1/3 of the reference outer radius r :

$$r_{\text{ring}} = \frac{r}{3} = \frac{2.36 \times 10^{20}}{3} = 7.867 \times 10^{19} \text{ m}$$

2.2 Ring Orbital Frequency

The Keplerian orbital frequency of a test mass at r_{ring} within the total gravitational potential:

$$\omega_{\text{ring}} = \sqrt{\frac{GM}{r_{\text{ring}}^3}}$$

Substituting values:

$$\omega_{\text{ring}} = \sqrt{\frac{6.674 \times 10^{-11} \times 1.989 \times 10^{41}}{(7.867 \times 10^{19})^3}}$$

Computing the denominator:

$$r_{\text{ring}}^3 = (7.867 \times 10^{19})^3 = 4.871 \times 10^{59} \text{ m}^3$$

$$\omega_{\text{ring}} = \sqrt{\frac{1.327 \times 10^{31}}{4.871 \times 10^{59}}} = \sqrt{2.724 \times 10^{-29}} = 1.650 \times 10^{-14} \text{ rad/s}$$

2.3 Ring Orbital Period

$$T_{\text{ring}} = \frac{2\pi}{\omega_{\text{ring}}} = \frac{6.2832}{1.650 \times 10^{-14}} = 3.808 \times 10^{14} \text{ s} = 12.08 \text{ Myr}$$

This is a physically reasonable orbital period for a ring structure at $\sim 8 \times 10^{19}$ m from the galactic centre.

2.4 Proximity Enhancement Factor

The gravitational influence of the ring mass m_{ring} at the reference point r (located a distance $\Delta r = r - r_{\text{ring}} = 2r/3$ from the ring) scales as:

$$g_{\text{ring at } r} \propto \frac{Gm_{\text{ring}}}{\Delta r^2} = \frac{Gm_{\text{ring}}}{(2r/3)^2} = \frac{9}{4} \cdot \frac{Gm_{\text{ring}}}{r^2}$$

The base term already includes the full galaxy at radius r . The ring contribution uses the ratio of effective distances:

$$\text{Proximity factor} = \left(\frac{r}{r_{\text{ring}}} \right)^2 = \left(\frac{r}{r/3} \right)^2 = 3^2 = 9$$

This gives a **9× proximity enhancement**: the ring exerts 9 times more gravitational influence per unit mass at the reference point than the galaxy average.

2.5 Ring Gravitational Perturbation Amplitude

$$A_{\text{ring}} = 9 \cdot f_{\text{ring}} \cdot g_{\text{base}}$$

where: - $f_{\text{ring}} = 0.001$ = dust ring mass fraction (0.1% of total galaxy mass) - $g_{\text{base}} = G \cdot M / r^2 = 2.382 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m/s}^2$

$$A_{\text{ring}} = 9 \times 0.001 \times 2.382 \times 10^{-10} = 2.144 \times 10^{-12} \text{ m/s}^2$$

2.6 Full Ring Resonator Term

$$F_{\text{ring}}(t) = A_{\text{ring}} \cdot \cos(\omega_{\text{ring}} \cdot t)$$

This is a **pure oscillatory term** — no exponential decay, consistent with the ring's stable configuration. As the ring orbits, it imposes a periodic modulation on the vacuum field energy density at the reference point r with period $T_{\text{ring}} = 12.08 \text{ Myr}$.

3. Physical Interpretation: UQFF Gravitational Ring Resonator

3.1 Ring as Vacuum Field Oscillator

In the UQFF framework, mass concentrations modulate the vacuum energy density through their gravitational potential. A ring moving in a stable Keplerian orbit generates a time-periodic perturbation in the local UQFF field:

$$\delta \rho_{\text{vac}}(t) = \delta \rho_{\text{vac},0} \cdot \cos(\omega_{\text{ring}} t + \phi_0)$$

This is equivalent to a **tuned resonator** in the vacuum field — a structure that cycles energy at a characteristic frequency. The Sombrero dust ring is therefore the first identified **stable UQFF Gravitational Ring Resonator** in the catalogue.

3.2 Comparison with Orbital Periods

Object	Orbital period
Earth around Sun	1 year
Outer Milky Way disk	~220 Myr
Sombrero dust ring	12.08 Myr
Andromeda outer HI ring	~90 Myr (PAPER_275 reference)

The Sombrero ring’s 12.08 Myr period places it in the intermediate-mass galaxy inner disc regime — rapid enough to generate significant temporal modulation of the UQFF field over cosmological baseline observations.

4. Module Implementation

```
// PAPER_278 – SOMBRERO_UQFF_MODULE.cpp, updateCache()
r_ring    = r / 3.0; // 7.867e19 m
omega_ring = std::sqrt(G_grav * M / (r_ring * r_ring * r_ring)); // 1.650e-14 rad/s
A_ring    = 9.0 * f_ring * g_base_cache; // 2.144e-12 m/s²

// Applied in computeResonantTerm():
double computeResonantTerm(double t) {
    return A_ring * std::cos(omega_ring * t); // pure oscillatory – no decay
}
```

Computed values for Sombrero M104:

Quantity	Value	Units
$r_{\text{ring}} = r/3$	7.867×10^{19}	m
ω_{ring}	1.650×10^{-14}	rad/s
$T_{\text{ring}} = 2\pi/\omega_{\text{ring}}$	12.08	Myr
f_{ring}	0.001	dimensionless
Proximity factor	9.0	dimensionless
A_{ring}	2.144×10^{-12}	m/s²
g_{BH} (PAPER_279) for comparison	2.382×10^{-12}	m/s²

Note: $A_{\text{ring}} \approx g_{\text{BH}}$ in magnitude — the ring resonance and BH contribution are comparable at leading order.

5. Key Constants Introduced

Symbol	Value	Units	Description
ω_{ring}	1.650×10^{-14}	rad/s	Dust Ring UQFF Orbital Resonance Frequency
r_{ring}	$r/3 = 7.867 \times 10^{19}$	m	Dust ring reference radius
T_{ring}	12.08	Myr	Ring orbital period
f_{ring}	0.001	dimensionless	Dust ring mass fraction
A_{ring}	2.144×10^{-12}	m/s²	Ring resonance amplitude
Proximity factor	9	dimensionless	$(r/r_{\text{ring}})^2 = 3^2 = 9$

6. Physical Significance

1. **First stable UQFF ring resonator:** All prior UQFF ring terms (Andromeda PAPER_275) decayed exponentially. The Sombrero dust ring is the first pure undamped oscillator, establishing a new class of UQFF boundary condition.
2. **Observable prediction:** The UQFF ring resonance produces a 12.08 Myr periodic modulation in the effective gravitational acceleration at $r = 2.36 \times 10^{20}$ m with amplitude $A_{\text{ring}} = 2.14 \times 10^{-12}$ m/s². While below direct observational reach today, this is a testable UQFF prediction for future stellar spectroscopic surveys.
3. **Ring-BH coupling:** Noting that $A_{\text{ring}} \approx g_{\text{BH}}$ (both $\sim 2.1\text{--}2.4 \times 10^{-12}$ m/s²), the ring and BH gravitational contributions are comparable at the reference radius — unique among UQFF modules where the BH term is typically sub-dominant to the 26-layer Triadic sum.
4. **Scale-free ring resonator formula:** $F_{\text{ring}} = (r/r_{\text{ring}})^2 \cdot f_{\text{ring}} \cdot g_{\text{base}} \cdot \cos(\sqrt{(GM/r_{\text{ring}}^3) \cdot t})$ provides a general template applicable to any galaxy with a measurable equatorial ring structure.

UQFF computed: Canonical UQFF buoyancy parameter $U_{\text{bi}} = \sqrt{SSq} GM/r\kappa = 5.0\text{e-}40.576.67\text{e-}11\text{M/r}$; for solar parameters: $U_{\text{bi,Sun}} = 5.7\text{e-}46.67\text{e-}111.99\text{e}30/(6.96\text{e}8) = 1.47\text{e+}2$ m/s.

7. References

- PAPER_275: Andromeda HI Ring UQFF Decaying Ring Term $A_{\text{ring}} \times \exp(-\alpha t) \times \cos(\omega t)$
- PAPER_279: Sombrero SMBH Dominance Ratio γ_{BH} and r_{SOI} (companion paper)
- Emsellem, E. et al. (2004). MNRAS, 352, 721. (M104 structure)
- Jarrel, J. R. et al. (2011). ApJ, 739, 21. (Sombrero DM halo and dust ring observations)
- de Zeeuw, P. T. et al. (1996). MNRAS, 280, 167. (Sombrero galaxy kinematics)
- Tempel, E., & Tenjes, P. (2006). MNRAS, 371, 1269. (M104 surface photometry and ring structure)

UQFF 2.0 — $F_{\text{ring}} = A_{\text{ring}} \cdot \cos(\omega_{\text{ring}} \cdot t)$ is additive to the Triadic MUGE master equation. The stable ring resonator represents a new class of UQFF gravitational boundary condition. — Daniel T. Murphy, Session 77, March 2026.